

Question:

What is aschizo-affectivedisorder ?

Answer Choices:

- A. A schizo-affective disorder is a term used to describe a personality disorder with features similar to both schizophrenia and affective disorders.
- B. A schizo-affective disorder exclusively involves psychotic symptoms without any mood disturbances.
- C. A schizo-affective disorder is a psychological condition where mood disorders occur as a reaction to schizophrenia treatment.
- D. A schizo-affective disorder is characterized by periods of well-being between episodes of schizophrenia and mood disorders.
- E. A schizo-affective disorder is a combination of schizophrenic and affective disorders, where the affective symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.
- F. A schizo-affective disorder is a subtype of affective disorders.
- G. A schizo-affective disorder is a subtype of schizophrenia.
- H. A schizo-affective disorder develops after the onset of psychosis.
- I. A schizo-affective disorder is a chronic condition with only affective or mood-related symptoms.
- J. A schizo-affective disorder is a mild form of schizophrenia that does not include affective symptoms.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
Schizo-affective disorder is a severe mental illness that simultaneously meets diagnostic criteria for both schizophrenia and a primary mood disorder (typically major depressive or manic episodes). The defining feature is the co-occurrence of psychotic symptoms (such as delusions , hallucinations) with mood-related symptoms (depressed , manic , or mixed) within the same episode ; mood symptoms are prominent and not merely secondary to psychotic symptoms or treatment . It is not simply a prodromal or post-onset phase (rules out H) and is not a mild form of schizophrenia without affect (rules out J). It is not merely a subtype of schizophrenia (rules out G) or an affective disorder (rules out F), nor does it require mood symptoms to begin after psychosis (rules out C). There is no requirement that affective symptoms precede psychosis (so E is overly restrictive), and it is not exclusively without mood disturbance (rules out B and I).

Correct Answer : D . A schizo-affective disorder is characterized by periods of well-being between episodes of schizophrenia and mood disorders .

</think>
<answer>
D . A schizo-affective disorder is characterized by periods of well-being between episodes of schizophrenia and mood disorders .

</answer>